

Data Dictionary & Protocol

Project: Effectiveness of Psychotherapy for Depression

Dataset File: data_depression_therapy.csv

1. Dataset Overview

This dataset contains extracted effect sizes from 124 primary studies comparing psychotherapy to control conditions for adults with depression. It is a sub-sample of a larger dataset of studies.

- **Total Rows:** 230
- **Total Studies:** 124
- **Metric:** Standardized Mean Difference (SMD) computed in Hedges' g. Positive values indicate the intervention was more effective than the control.

2. Variable Dictionary

Variable Name	Description	Coding Details
study	Unique Study Identifier	Author and Year of the primary study. Note: Some studies may contribute multiple rows.
es_id	Effect Size ID	Unique identifier for each specific comparison/outcome within the dataset.
yi	Effect Size (SMD)	The calculated Standardized Mean Difference (Hedges' g).
vi	Sampling Variance	The variance of the effect size (used for weighting in meta-analysis).

target_group	Population	The specific age or demographic group targeted, in this case: <i>Adults</i> .
format	Delivery Format	How the therapy was delivered: • <i>Individual</i> • <i>Group</i> • <i>Guided Self-Help</i> • <i>Other</i>
diagnosis	Assessment Method	How depression was defined for inclusion: • <i>Diagnosis</i> (Clinical interview) • <i>Cut-off score</i> (Self-report score exceeding a clinical threshold) • <i>Subclinical</i> (Elevated symptoms but no full diagnosis)
type	Therapy Type	The theoretical orientation of the intervention: • <i>CBT-based</i> (Cognitive Behavioral Therapy) • <i>Not-CBT-based</i> (Interpersonal, Psychodynamic, etc.)

control	Control Condition	The comparator group: • <i>WL</i> (Waiting List) • <i>CAU</i> (Care As Usual) • <i>Other</i> (Pill placebo, psychological placebo, etc.)
region	Location	Geographical region where the study was conducted (<i>Europe, North America, etc.</i>).
risk_of_bias	Quality Assessment	Rating of the study's methodological quality: • <i>Low</i> • <i>Some Concern</i>

3. Notes for the Analyst

- **Effect Direction:** A positive *yi* indicates that the Psychotherapy group had better outcomes (lower depression) than the Control group.
- **Dependency:** Be aware that the number of rows (230) exceeds the number of unique studies (124). You must decide how to handle studies that report multiple effect sizes to ensure your analysis satisfies statistical assumptions.